

Rudolph Pešek Lecturers, IAA Symposium on SETI (session A4.1)

The Pešek Lecture is the keynote of the SETI I session (A4.1, SETI Science and Technology) of the IAA Symposium on the Search for Extraterrestrial Intelligence at the International Astronautical Congress. It honours Prof. Rudolph Pešek of the Czechoslovak Academy of Sciences, who coined the acronym CETI and was the first Chair of the IAA's CETI Committee, forerunner of the SETI Committee.

Year	Congress	Lecturer	Lecture
2026	Antalya	David MacMahon	The first decade of Breakthrough Listen
2025	Sydney	Steve Croft	Enhancing the Breakthrough Listen Technosignature Search with Advances in Anomaly Detection.
2024	Milan	Daniel Czech	Early Results from Breakthrough Listen's Automated Commensal Technosignature Survey at MeerKAT
2023	Baku	Vishal Gajjar	Expanding the Search for ETI through Wide-Band and Broadband Pulsed Signals
2022	Paris	Karen Perez	Breakthrough Listen Search for Intelligent Life in the Galactic Plane with the Parkes Telescope
2021	Dubai	Steve Croft?	Breakthrough Listen: Green Bank Telescope Observations, Analysis, and Public Data
2020	Online (CyberSpace Edition)	Steve Croft?	The Breakthrough Listen Search for Extraterrestrial Intelligence: Overview
2019	Washington DC	Andrew Siemion	New Limits on the Presence of Technological Civilizations in the Universe from Breakthrough Listen
2018	Bremen	J. Emilio Enriquez	The Breakthrough Listen Search for Intelligent Life: the first SETI results and other future projects
2017	Adelaide	Michael Garrett	All-sky radio SETI
2016	Guadalajara	<i>Not known</i>	
2015	Jerusalem	Amri Wandel	On the Abundance of Extraterrestrial Life after Kepler
2014	Toronto	Michael Garrett	SETI, Big Data, and the Next Generation of Radio Telescopes
2013	Beijing	Shin-ya Narusawa	Project Dorothy: Joint Worldwide SETI Observation
2012	Naples	No lecture given	
2011	Cape Town	Martin Dominik	Exploration Rather Than Speculation
2010	Prague	<i>Not known</i>	
2009	Daejeon	Myung-Hyun Rhee	The SETI Programs in Korea: Progress Report
2008	Glasgow	William J. (Jack) Welch	The Allen Telescope Array: the First Widefield, Panoramic, Snapshot Radio Camera for Radio Astronomy and SETI
2007	Hyderabad	Govind Swarup	GMRT, SKA and SETI
2006	Valencia	Claudio Maccone	SETI, Extrasolar Planet Searches, and Interstellar Flight: When Are They Going To Merge?
2005	Fukuoka	<i>Not known</i>	
2004	Vancouver	<i>Not known</i>	
2003	Bremen	Claudio Maccone	Innovative SETI by the KLT

Year	Congress	Lecturer	Lecture
2002	Houston	Frank Drake	Promising New Approaches in the Search for Extraterrestrial Intelligence
2001	Toulouse	<i>Not known</i>	
2000	Rio de Janeiro	William J. (Jack) Welch	Building SETI's First Dedicated Observatory

? == TBC.

Sources

IAA SETI Permanent Committee, "Annual Rudolph Pesek Lecture" (setileague.org/iaaseti/pesek.htm, last updated 14 September 2015): 2000–2015. The source spells 2011's lecturer "Martin Dominick"; corrected here to Martin Dominik.

IAA SETI Permanent Committee, programme of the 43rd Symposium on SETI, IAC 2014 Toronto (setileague.org/iaaseti/prog14.htm): confirms 2014.

IAF Congress browser programmes for IAC-17 to IAC-25, sessions A4.1 and A4.2 (iafastro.directory), saved March 2026. The lectures are labelled KEYNOTE in 2022, 2023 and 2024 only.

Compiled by Michael Garrett, 28 September 2026